

Vocabulary

Abbreviations, Acronyms and contractions

Abbreviations and acronyms are shortened forms of words or phrases. An abbreviation is typically a shortened form of words used to represent the whole (such as Dr. or Prof.) while an acronym contains a set of initial letters from a phrase that usually form another word (such as radar or scuba).

Abbreviations and acronyms are often interchanged, yet the two are quite distinct. The main point of reference is that abbreviations are merely a series of letters while acronyms form new words.

We use contractions (I'm, we're) in everyday speech and informal writing. Contractions, which are sometimes called 'short forms', commonly combine a pronoun or noun and a verb, or a verb and not, in a shorter form.

Contractions with I, you, he, she, it, we, and they

'm	=	am (I'm)
're	=	are (you're, we're, they're)
's	=	is and has (he's, she's, it's)
've	=	have ('ve, you've, we've, they've)
'll	=	will (I'll, you'll, he'll, she'll, it'll, we'll, they'll)
'd	=	had and would (I'd, you'd, he'd, she'd, it'd, we'd, they'd)

Contractions with auxiliary verb and not

The contraction for not is n't:

aren't	=	are not (we aren't, you aren't)
can't	=	cannot
couldn't	=	could not
didn't	=	did not (I didn't, they didn't)

C. Pick out the contractions from the lesson and expand them.

Contractions	Expansions

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